



Test run: Watermarks, ads, and the controls users lost

Product gaps, emerging markets, and AI updates from October 1 – October 6, 2026.

This is a short test issue that exercises the weekly publishing flow. It is not a numbered week. Items are ranked within each section, most important first. Every claim links to its source; numbers appear only where a cited source states them.

A light issue. OpenAI started watermarking ChatGPT text in the EU and announced display ads beside generated images. ChatGPT users reported losing controls they relied on, and seed money went to likeness licensing, personal AI hardware, and safety for AI-driven robots.

● Gaps · missing pieces in real products (3) ● Markets · what is emerging (4) ● AI · the week's key updates (3)

GAPS

Missing gaps in real apps and products

Real product, the missing piece, and why nobody covers it yet.

1.1 AI-text watermarks fade after light editing, and there is no shared detector

MISSING A way for publishers, schools, or platforms to check text from any vendor, one that still works after light editing.

EVIDENCE OpenAI will watermark ChatGPT and Codex text in the EU to comply with the AI Act's transparency rules. TechCrunch reports that in OpenAI's own test, replacing 10% of words with synonyms cut detection from about 92% to 66%, and that short passages, math, and translations are harder to detect. Anthropic watermarks Claude text separately.

WHY OPEN Each lab marks its own output, and the report doesn't describe a public checker that works across vendors.

[TechCrunch](#)

1.2 ChatGPT: users report they can no longer switch models inside a conversation

MISSING Switching to a better-suited model partway through a conversation, without starting a new chat and losing context.

EVIDENCE An Oct 4 OpenAI Community bug report from a paid user says in-chat model switching disappeared and that memory is often not applied in long chats. A reply reports similar memory problems since mid-August.

WHY OPEN The user describes it as an unannounced change. We found no explanation from OpenAI.

[OpenAI Community thread](#)

1.3 ChatGPT web: users rely on browser extensions to see edited-message versions and export full chats

MISSING Built-in navigation of message versions and branches, plus a complete export of a single conversation.

EVIDENCE A long-running OpenAI Community bug thread about the removed version arrows was still active on Oct 2. Users describe extensions breaking as the web endpoints change, and an extension developer posting fixes.

WHY OPEN Users say third-party extensions are the only workaround, and those break each time the site changes.

[OpenAI Community thread](#)

MARKETS

Emerging markets

What is actually showing up: new categories, rounds, launches, and the forces creating demand.

2.1 Licensing data, creative work, and likeness for AI

SignSplit came out of stealth on Oct 5. Its press release announces a \$400M strategic seed with W Group at a \$1B valuation for a service that lets people and institutions protect, license, and contribute their data, work, and likeness.

[PR Newswire](#)

2.2 Dedicated hardware for personal AI

Ghost came out of stealth with an \$11M seed led by Andreessen Horowitz. It is building a \$3,499 computer meant to run a personal AI.

[TechCrunch](#)

2.3 Safety for robots driven by generative AI

Safeworld came out of stealth with a seed round of more than \$12M, led by Shine Capital and a16z Speedrun. It focuses on convincing people that robots driven by generative AI are safe to be around.

[TechCrunch](#)

2.4 Infrastructure for real-time world models

Reactor, a developer platform for real-time generative video and world models, said NVIDIA and Sapphire Ventures joined its Lightspeed-led Series A. The company cites adoption across media, entertainment, and physical AI. No amount was disclosed in the release.

[Business Wire via FinancialContent](#)

AI The most important AI updates this week

What changed and why it matters.

3.1 OpenAI will watermark ChatGPT and Codex text in the EU

WHAT CHANGED Announced Oct 5. The invisible watermark rolls out over the coming weeks to EU users on all plans to meet the AI Act's transparency rules, which took effect Aug 2. API developers anywhere can turn it on for select models; it is off by default.

WHY IT MATTERS EU rules are now changing how a major AI product works by default in one region. Products that publish AI text in the EU will need a disclosure plan.

[TechCrunch](#)

3.2 OpenAI adds display ads beside generated images

WHAT CHANGED Visual ads will appear next to images that ChatGPT generates, starting later this month in the U.S. with an initial test group of advertisers. OpenAI also announced more measurement partners and brand-suitability pilots with DoubleVerify and IAS.

WHY IT MATTERS The free tier is becoming an ad business with standard ad-industry measurement tools.

[TechCrunch](#)

3.3 Google DeepMind watermarks AI-designed proteins (SynthID Bio)

WHAT CHANGED SynthID Bio embeds a signal in proteins during design. In lab tests, the marked proteins worked as well as unmarked ones. Running a marked sequence through another design tool removes the mark, and the method cannot identify who made a protein. DeepMind is releasing the code and data to researchers.

WHY IT MATTERS Provenance marking is spreading from media into biology, and so are its limits.

[Singularity Hub](#)

Preview issue: a test run of the weekly flow. TheGapBrief is published weekly by Open Mind Innovations LLC. This issue covers news published October 1 – October 6, 2026. Funding amounts and other figures are as reported by the linked sources; nothing here is investment advice.